

What other people said

We call the words that people say direct speech. If you want to tell someone what another person has said, it is called reported speech.

-  **New language** Reported speech
- Aa Vocabulary** Work and education
-  **New skill** Talking about people's lives

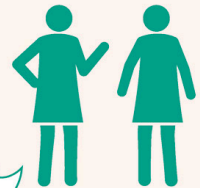
69.1 KEY LANGUAGE REPORTED SPEECH

In reported speech, the main verb usually "goes back" a tense. For example, the present simple changes to the past simple.



I **feel** sick.

Direct speech uses the present simple.



Luke said that he **felt** sick. I hope he's OK.

Reported speech uses the past simple here.

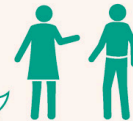


69.2 FURTHER EXAMPLES REPORTED SPEECH



Your house **is** really beautiful.

She said our house **was** really beautiful.



TIP
You can leave out "that" after "said" in reported speech.



Your suit **looks** great.

He said that my suit **looked** great.



69.3 HOW TO FORM REPORTED SPEECH

The main verb in reported speech is usually "said." The rest of the sentence is usually in the past tense.

